



*The top Greek warriors
climbed inside the
wooden horse.*

The two armies fought on. During one battle, Paris was slain by a Greek archer. Still, the Trojans did not let Helen return to the Greeks, and the two sides were still evenly matched. It was the clever Greek hero Odysseus who realized the key to victory was to outwit the enemy. Odysseus went to the Greek architect Epeios and said, "Please build me a giant wooden horse. It should be big enough to hold fifty men in full armor in its belly."

Epeios did as he was asked, and the strongest Greek warriors, including Odysseus, hid inside the horse. Meanwhile, the rest of the soldiers abandoned their camp and took to their ships. They did not sail far, however. Odysseus had instructed them, "Go just far enough so you are out of sight of Troy. The Trojans will think we've given up and gone home."



*The next day, the Trojans saw the ships had
gone and thought the Greeks had left.*

Just as Odysseus had planned, the Trojans were ecstatic when they saw the Greek camp deserted. They believed the wooden horse was a gift to the gods from the Greeks, and they decided to bring it inside the city walls. Although some of the Trojans thought they should build a bonfire and burn the horse, others wished to keep it to give to the gods themselves. It was the second group who won.

That day, the streets of Troy were filled with people singing and dancing. Meanwhile, the Greek soldiers lay in wait. When night fell and the last